Two reasons were given for postponement of the date. First, there was Soviet pressure to postpone the date for the launch of the war, with the promise that if the summit did not bring about any change, the Soviet Union would provide offensive weapons. There was strong pressure on Assad to postpone during his visit to the Soviet Union at the end of April 1973. Second, reliable sources also reported that the Egyptian army was still lacking in its offensive capabilities and that the army was not ready.

The first (undetailed) report on Egypt's decision to postpone the launch of the war came in May 1973. Among the reasons given were the need to complete preparations and to receive new weapons from the Soviet Union, and the Syrian request to postpone for the same reasons. At the same time, a report was received from another source claiming that the signs of imminent war had disappeared.

Isolated Early Warnings about July–August 1973

A single source reported on a plan to open fire simultaneously on both the Egyptian and Syrian fronts on July 15, 1973, *which would begin with a comprehensive army exercise* on July 3. Another source reported on the possibility of the war being launched between August 10 and August 15, adding that July 23, Egyptian Revolution Day, had also been mentioned.

Time C: September–October 1973

"Time C," September–October 1973, was the direct continuation of "Time B"—late April to early June 1973, but at Time C, the armament that had been the condition for Egypt's readiness for war had been completed. Leading up to this date, an unprecedented number of reports came in describing preparations on the ground. From mid-July 1973 to October 6, the date that the war broke out, the Mossad provided twenty-three unambiguous warnings from its most reliable sources, including Egypt's and Syria's detailed war plans. It should be noted once again that all of the early warnings that came in between September 8 and October 5, fifteen in total, were from a variety of sources. Not one of them came from Ashraf Marwan.